



VANDERWOUDE/TANANBAUM

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MAURICE SIEVAN (1898-1981)

March 1 - April 2

Maurice Sievan's late monumental paintings - haunting images of faceless incipient colossi - will be on view at the Vanderwoude Tananbaum Gallery from March 1 to April 2. The exhibition comprises twelve major works, including the Museum of Modern Art's "Oompalik". The gallery is the exclusive representative for the Sievan estate.

Heroic in size and conception, these dramatic canvases were executed towards the end of Maurice Sievan's career, from 1958 through the 1960's. They represented a marked departure - in sensibility, imagery and scale - from the artist's earlier pastoral landscapes. The late paintings, last presented in 1974 at the Queens Museum retrospective, are an aspect of Sievan's work that needs to be re-examined.

In these pictures, loosely articulated forms, generally delineating one or two looming amorphous figures, are built up from layers of "running washes" with abrupt slashes of color - often broad red or white strokes on a dark ground. Half-shrouded features emerge from and recede within the surrounding veils of paint.

Maurice Sievan's cryptically titled oils have a disturbing air. The personages they depict are mythic archetypes drawn from some universal human nightmare. These powerful paintings brought a new range to Sievan's vision, reaffirming his stature as an artist of serious import.

"The horrifying imagination of Goya is here, as well as something peculiar to the modern and primitive painter: his premonition of catastrophe.",
DORE ASHTON, The New York Times, April 30, 1960

"Through the myriad and often disturbing turns of styles and movements of the 20th century, Mr. Sievan has followed a course of his own ... it has also enabled him to produce something individual and inward.", HILTON KRAMER,
The New York Times, March 15, 1974

Gallery hours: Tuesday to Saturday, 10:00-5:30
Mondays by appointment only

Co-owners, Suzanne Vanderwoude and Dorothy Tananbaum

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VANDERWOUDE TANANBAUM GALLERY 24 E 81 STREET/NEW YORK CITY 10028/212.879.8200